

CADWELL REALTY GROUP

Albany, Oregon Real Estate

Albany Home Buyer's Checklist

Everything you need to do before, during, and after buying a home in Albany, Oregon

BEFORE YOU START

- Check your credit score — aim for 700+ for best conventional rates
- Calculate your debt-to-income ratio (keep below 43%)
- Save for down payment — 3.5% FHA minimum, 20% to avoid PMI
- Save for closing costs — budget 2–3% of purchase price
- Get pre-approved (not just pre-qualified) from a local lender
- Determine your must-haves vs. nice-to-haves in a home
- Research Albany neighborhoods: North Albany, South Albany, Historic Downtown, Knox Butte, Oak Creek
- Interview and choose a local Albany buyer's agent

DURING YOUR SEARCH

- Set up MLS alerts for your target price range and neighborhoods
- Tour at least 5–8 homes before making an offer
- Track homes you've toured with notes on pros and cons
- Confirm school attendance zones for any home you're serious about
- Verify whether North Albany addresses are in Linn or Benton County
- Research comparable sales before making any offer
- Get a pre-offer CMA from your agent on homes you love
- Review HOA documents if applicable before writing an offer

MAKING AN OFFER

- Confirm your earnest money amount (1–2% standard in Albany)
- Decide on inspection contingency period (10 days standard in Oregon)
- Decide whether to include appraisal contingency
- Review financing contingency terms with your lender
- Understand escalation clause strategy if multiple offers expected
- Have your pre-approval letter ready to submit with offer
- Confirm your target closing timeline with your lender

UNDER CONTRACT

- Schedule home inspection within contingency period (10 business days)
- Attend home inspection in person if possible

- Review inspection report carefully with your agent
- Submit repair requests or credit requests within deadline
- Order appraisal through your lender
- Maintain financial status — do not open new credit or change jobs
- Purchase homeowner's insurance before closing
- Do final walkthrough 24–48 hours before closing

CLOSING DAY

- Bring government-issued photo ID
- Confirm wire transfer or cashier's check amount with escrow
- Review all closing documents carefully before signing
- Confirm deed recording with title company
- Receive keys — you're a homeowner!

Questions at any stage? Call Jason Cadwell at (541) 619-4303 — no pressure, no obligation.

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